

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 736

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend Steve Hiatt on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those esteemed professionals who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of public service; and

WHEREAS, Steve Hiatt is one such estimable person, who has taken his well-deserved retirement after more than three decades of distinguished service in public and economic development, having most recently served with dedication, ability, and integrity as director of existing business development for the Chattanooga Area Chamber of Commerce; and

WHEREAS, raised in Florida, Mr. Hiatt moved to Tennessee in 1975; he attended Chattanooga State Community College and the University of Tennessee at Chattanooga, where he earned a bachelor's degree in political science in 1978; and

WHEREAS, prior to his work in economic development, Steve Hiatt served in a variety of public and governmental roles, including service as assistant city manager of Red Bank and as district chief of staff for former Congresswoman Marilyn Lloyd, gaining valuable experience in problem-solving, constituent service, and collaborative leadership across multiple levels of government; and

WHEREAS, in 1989, Mr. Hiatt entered the field of economic development, serving with the Tennessee Department of Economic and Community Development and later with Partners for Economic Progress and RiverValley Partners; and

WHEREAS, in 1998, when Chattanooga's public economic development functions moved to the Chattanooga Chamber of Commerce, Steve Hiatt officially became a core part of the team where he would serve with leadership and dedication for many years; and

WHEREAS, from his early days serving as founding president of the JFK Club and later as president and officer of the Hamilton County Young Democrats, Mr. Hiatt built early experience in community leadership; he served on the Tennessee Small Business Development Center's Advisory Board and the Southeast Tennessee Workforce Development Board, helping shape some of the policies and programs that are still in place today; and

WHEREAS, Steve Hiatt played a key role in the recruitment, retention, and expansion of businesses across Hamilton County and the surrounding region, contributing to the creation of tens of thousands of jobs, the generation of billions of dollars in capital investment, and the strengthening of workforce and infrastructure resources that continue to benefit the region today; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Hiatt worked closely with his counterparts at the city and county level, and made significant contributions to the expansions and locations of employers like McKee Foods, Volkswagen, Gestamp, and many more companies of every size across the Chattanooga region; he also had a hand in recruiting nearly every major employer in Enterprise South and Centre South industrial parks, stepping in along the way to solve problems big and small, from hiring issues to the occasional pothole; and

WHEREAS, in recognition of his leadership and outstanding achievements in economic development, Steve Hiatt received the Fred H. Harris Professional of the Year Award from the Tennessee Economic Development Council, an honor presented annually to individuals whose work has made significant contributions to both their local communities and the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Mr. Hiatt earned a reputation as a thoughtful, reliable, and effective advocate for the businesses and communities he served, and he should be recognized on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and commend Steve Hiatt for his exemplary service to the

Chattanooga Area Chamber of Commerce, expressing our sincere appreciation for his lasting contributions to the economic strength and prosperity of the Chattanooga region and this State and extending to him our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.